

Remix Tools

- Cakewalk Plasma and Cakewalk Club: Tracks for loop creation and remixing
- Sound Forge 5.0 and Cool Edit Pro: Audio editors for tweaking loops and audio files
- Reason: A sophisticated synthesiser studio system with a sequencer; great for remixing
- Cubase VST: A fairly complex audio recording and editing software used by professional remix artists
- Other popular software: Mixman Studio, Groovemaker 2.0, PCDJ Silver, Ez-Mixer and Rave Ejay

accepts WAV and MP3 formats as well as the .acd format.

Once all your tracks are in the Track List, you can layout the sequence or order of the loops or sounds on the Track View by simply drawing them in, and playing them together to see how they sound.

If you want to change the order of the loops, simply shift them around on the Track View. You can easily adjust the beats per minute (BPM) and keep dragging and deleting tracks as many times as you want. ACID automatically time-stretches samples so that they fit into the tempo of the song you are working on.

ACID Pro saves your mix in the .acd format, which is compatible with a lot of other software such as Cakewalk. You can even record from an audio device plugged into a soundcard, record your mix and play it back.

The ACID Pro version lets you rip and burn CDs and save files, but all this is disabled in ACID Xpress, the demo version. Exporting or saving is also disabled but you can record your mix and play it back. Use the demo version to get a hang of the software and how to remix music. Later, when you're sure that you think of remixing as something more than a hobby, you can invest in the Professional version.

Sonic Foundry, the developers of ACID, have a portal called www.acidplanet.com where you can

To get a hang of what sound effects to use and how to sequence patterns, load a song that comes with the FruityLoops library and notice how the remixer has used patterns and elements for your guidelines.

TIP

download loops and samples and publish your music.

Some Trance please

Browsing through available sound samples won't satisfy you. Create your own loops or even some trance music with FruityLoops.

FruityLoops can be a bit intimidating at first with its array of controls and settings. Stick with it and you'll find that it's not that tough to create basic tunes—things get easier as you get the hang of it.

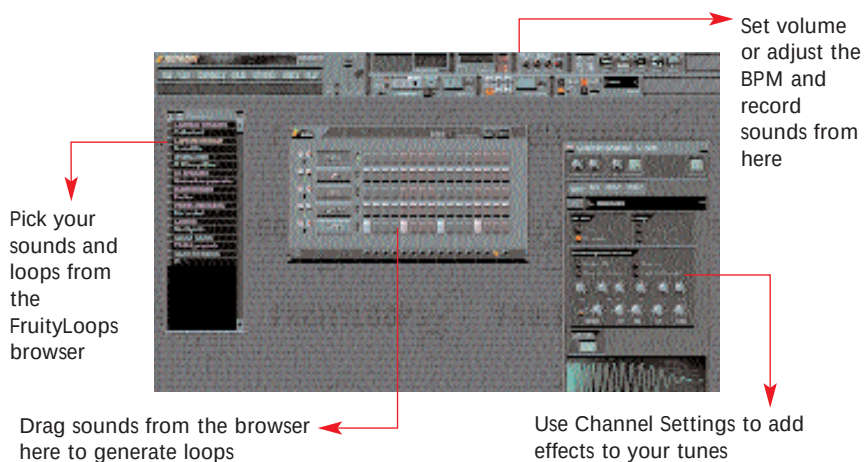
Let's first understand how FruityLoops creates loops. This is a pattern-based sequencer, which means that you compose your songs in pieces or patterns that you later put together to make a tune or a loop.

You create patterns using the sound library, which has instrument sounds, drumbeats, synthesiser sounds, vocal sounds and even full-length tracks. It also has built-in generators that use the sounds to get the melody going.

Now let's help you create your first pattern. The top bar of FruityLoops contains the menu, the volume and tempo controls, and the beat counter. There are a lot of 'floating menus' such as the Browser which gives you easy access to the sound libraries, loop generators and channel settings—the place where you add effects to your tunes.

Close all menus except for the Browser and the channel window (see *screen-shot*). You'll see a channel window with

Creating your own Tunes in FruityLoops



Glossary

Beats: A pulsing unit of musical time is considered a beat.
Crossfading: An audio editing technique in which one sound is faded out as another moves in, allowing for a smooth transition between the two. Crossfading is common in samplers, where it is used to smoothen loop transitions (crossfade looping) and sound design to create hybrid sounds (one sound morphing or turning into another).
Loop: A sound that continually repeats itself over and over again.
Mixer: A device used to combine and adjust sounds from a variety of sources in order to create a final recorded audio product, such as the soundtrack of a movie.
Notes: The symbol used to indicate the duration and pitch of each sound. Also used to describe the actual sounds pro-

duced by an instrument when reproducing the tones indicated by these written symbols.
Samplers: Recording devices that can record almost any sound digitally and make this recording accessible to a synthesizer or computer.
Sequencers: An electronic device or software program that can be instructed to order and modify digitally stored musical sounds for playback, as through a synthesizer.
Tempo: The speed at which a piece of music is played is referred to as its tempo.
Tracks: Any piece of music on a recorded and playback medium is referred to as a track. 'Track' is also used to refer to a single aspect of music that has been recorded in the 'record' production process.